

nuts with bulk toilet paper, cases of vegetables, and tomato products.

Hang it off the door.

There are all kinds of products out there at various department stores that hook over the tops of doors, keeping even the pickiest rental landlord happy. Some of them have fabric pockets. Some have the sturdy wire shelving for canned goods. Either way, it's typically unused real estate when it comes to storing extra goods. This may not work for the more formal home decorators out there. But those of you renting may find it valuable for reaching larger financial goals sooner.

Shove it in a corner pantry.

I've drooled over the one my friend has in her kitchen for years. The major benefit of these things is that an unbelievable amount of stuff can be stored in a convenient location where the square footage is usually ignored. Include a canned goods rotator, and you're really in business. Renters can make one of these on the cheap by using a rod or tension cable across the corner and hanging a long curtain in a fabric that makes sense for them. Using a folding screen room divider would also be another way to go.

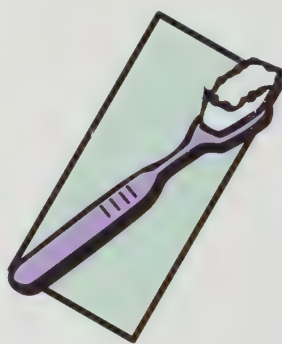
2. What to buy?

While individual items will undoubtedly vary from household to house-

hold, I've come up with three flexible categories that I believe everyone can relate to: non-food consumables, family favorites, and something I call "consumable infrastructure."

Non-food consumables

This is different for every family, but can include things like batteries, cotton balls and swabs, shampoo, deodorant, feminine products, laundry soap, toothpaste, and the like. Basically, this category includes any non-edible items you have to replace on a regular basis.



Family favorites

These include any items your family goes through on a regular basis that are unique to your home. For us, canned tomato products are high on the list, as are frozen 1-pound bullets of turkey sausage, 10-pound bags of chicken legs, bar items, bulk canned clams, and pasta. Again, this list will differ from family to family. Honor your own style.